MANATOBI / ORIGINAL PRACTICE

英検2級
リーディングトレーニング

第12回 問題冊子

リスニング・英作文を含まない部分練習 ／ 全31問

大問	問題番号	内容
1	1〜17	短文の語句空所補充
2	18〜23	長文の語句空所補充
3	24〜31	読解

使い方

・解答用紙に答えを記入してください。問題冊子には正答を載せていません。
・問題・解説はA4縦、解答用紙はA4横。白黒・片面・実際のサイズ（100%）で印刷します。
・解き終わるまでは、別冊の解答・解説を開かないでください。
・同じ問題をアプリの分野別練習でも解けます。

独自作成した英検2級形式のリーディング第12回です。リスニング・英作文・面接は含みません。公式教材ではなく、CSE・合否換算はしません。筆記全体の公式時間をリーディングだけの時間に流用しません。外部難度校正は未実施です。

氏名：＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿

1

短文の語句空所補充
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

(1) To prevent old parchment scrolls from curling, the archive keeps vault humidity within a narrow ( ) year-round.

1 rank **2** range **3** rate **4** route

(2) Because the ferry pier sits exposed to westerly swells, docking maneuvers require ( ) timing from the captain.

1 impatient **2** implausible **3** impartial **4** impeccable

(3) Although the bakery's solar oven works admirably from April to October, overcast January weeks ( ) backup electric heat.

1 necessitate **2** negotiate **3** neutralize **4** nominate

(4) The botanical garden remained open during roof glazing repairs, ( ) with the central palm court cordoned off.

1 aboard **2** amidst **3** albeit **4** apart

(5) Before signing the joint research agreement, the university legal office had two ambiguous patent clauses ( ).

1 classified **2** clarified **3** cluttered **4** clung

1　短文の語句空所補充（続き）

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(6) Residents living beside the freight rail line have grown (　　) to the low rumble of midnight cargo trains.

1 accomplished　**2** accountable　**3** accustomed　**4** accumulated

(7) Even a five-percent improvement in hull smoothness can yield substantial fuel (　　) for transoceanic container ships.

1 symptoms　**2** samples　**3** sanctions　**4** savings

(8) Only by cross-referencing parish diaries with tide gauges (　　) meteorologists reconstruct the 1854 storm surge.

1 could　**2** can　**3** have　**4** were

(9) Because freshly harvested chestnuts turn moldy if sealed in plastic, farmers store them in breathable jute sacks to stay (　　).

1 vacated　**2** venerated　**3** validated　**4** ventilated

(10) When an unexpected frost damaged apricot blossoms, the jam maker (　　) the shortfall by buying surplus pears from a neighbor.

1 outgrew　**2** offset　**3** overheard　**4** overthrew

1 短文の語句空所補充（続き）

(11) Although both violins were carved in the same workshop, one projects brilliantly in large halls whereas the other sounds ( ) warm.

1 impulsively **2** infinitely **3** intimately **4** indifferently

(12) Any hiker planning to traverse the snowy ridge in April must carry crampons, as afternoon slush freezes into ( ) ice by dusk.

1 treacherous **2** trivial **3** talkative **4** temperate

(13) To ( ) collaboration across departments, the research institute placed its shared coffee bar right beside the main staircase.

1 culminate **2** cultivate **3** confiscate **4** captivate

(14) Even high-resolution satellite maps are no ( ) for walking a landslide slope in person to check hidden water seeps.

1 substitute **2** supplement **3** specimen **4** sanctuary

(15) When town funding for the summer lantern float ran short, local shopkeepers chipped ( ) fifty thousand yen apiece.

1 out **2** off **3** away **4** in

1　短文の語句空所補充（続き）

(16) All precision weights used on pharmacy scales undergo annual calibration to keep measurement errors within a hair's (　　).

1 height　**2** length　**3** breadth　**4** depth

(17) Far from making handwriting obsolete, tablet styluses have prompted software engineers to study how pen friction aids memory (　　).

1 rebellion　**2** retention　**3** recession　**4** redemption

2

長文の語句空所補充
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

Why Supermarket Shopping Carts Have Slightly Angled Front Casters

Push an empty shopping cart across a smooth supermarket floor, and it glides effortlessly around tight dairy corners with one hand. Try steering a heavy four-wheeled warehouse dolly whose wheels are all locked straight, by contrast, and turning requires lifting one end off the ground. Behind the shopping cart's nimble handling—and its occasional annoying wobble—lies subtle caster-wheel geometry.

A shopping cart pairs two fixed rear wheels with two front "swivel casters" that rotate 360 degrees. Look closely at a front wheel fork, and you will see the wheel axle sits a couple of centimeters BEHIND the vertical pivot pin attached to the cart frame. Engineers call that small offset "caster trail." Whenever you push the cart forward, floor friction pulls the wheel neatly into alignment behind the pivot, much like a weathervane aligning with the wind. (18), the cart tracks straight down long aisles without constant wrist corrections, yet pivots instantly when nudged sideways.

That helpful geometry becomes sensitive to dirt, however. Hair, string, or flat spots worn into polyurethane rubber by rough parking-lot asphalt can throw one front wheel slightly out of balance, triggering rapid side-to-side flutter at walking speed. (19), larger stores install magnetic wheel locks and smoother entryway pavers to keep carts off gritty curbs.

Next time a cart turns smoothly past a pyramid of apples, credit (20).

(18)

1 Despite the rear wheels
2 On the contrary
3 Otherwise
4 Thanks to this offset

(19)

1 To curb such wear
2 Conversely
3 By coincidence
4 Instead of steering

(20)

1 rough parking-lot gravel stuck inside the axle
2 four locked wheels that never rotate
3 a few centimeters of clever wheel geometry
4 magnets hidden inside pyramids of apples

How Oyster Reefs Clean Estuaries and Buffer Storm Waves

Mention coral reefs, and people immediately picture colorful tropical lagoons teeming with fish. Along cooler, murkier river mouths from Tokyo Bay and Chesapeake Bay to the North Sea, another reef builder once shaped coastlines on an equally vast scale: the humble oyster. Historical harbor charts from the seventeenth and eighteenth centuries show dense oyster beds rising meters thick across muddy estuaries—until heavy dredging and industrial pollution wiped out over eighty percent of them globally.

Marine restoration teams are now rebuilding oyster reefs not for seafood harvests, but for water quality and coastal defense. A single adult oyster pumps up to a hundred liters of murky water across its gills every day, filtering out excess microscopic algae fueled by farm and city runoff. Clearer water allows sunlight to reach seafloor eelgrass beds again, reviving oxygen levels and young flounder nurseries. (21), nitrogen locked into oyster shells and sediment no longer triggers suffocating summer "dead zones."

Oyster reefs act as living breakwaters too. As generations of new spat cement their rough shells atop older ones, the jagged calcium-carbonate ridge breaks incoming storm waves before they erode salt marshes and waterfront roads. Concrete seawalls crack and sink over decades, whereas a healthy oyster reef grows upward naturally to match rising sea levels. (22), volunteers collect clean discarded restaurant shells in mesh bags to give baby oysters hard surfaces to settle on.

Bringing filter-feeding shellfish back to urban bays demonstrates how nature-based restoration can (23).

(21)

1 On the contrary
2 In turn
3 Otherwise
4 Reluctantly

(22)

1 Conversely
2 Despite rising seas
3 To jump-start that growth
4 In vain

(23)

1 sink concrete seawalls deeper into muddy bays
2 turn temperate river mouths into tropical coral lagoons
3 sell polluted harbor oysters directly to restaurants
4 tackle murky water and coastal erosion at the same time

3 長文の内容一致選択
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

Submitting Slides Before the History Symposium

From: Organizing Desk, Regional High School History Symposium
To: Presenting Student Teams
Subject: Font-embedding rule and Tuesday upload deadline

Dear presenting teams,
We are looking forward to hearing your twelve-minute research presentations at Civic Auditorium next Saturday! Because sixteen schools are presenting back-to-back in one afternoon, participants will NOT connect personal laptops or tablets at the podium; all slides will run from a single auditorium Windows PC.

Please export your presentation in BOTH PowerPoint (.pptx) and PDF formats and upload them to our symposium folder by 5:00 p.m. on Tuesday. Decorative fonts downloaded on home Macs or iPads often vanish or scramble line breaks on another computer—check "Embed fonts in file" when saving, or stick to standard system fonts, and verify your PDF backup carefully.

Video clips must be embedded directly inside the slide file rather than linked to YouTube, as auditorium Wi-Fi is turned off during sessions.

Symposium Technical Team

Submitting Slides Before the History Symposium — Questions

(24) Why won't student teams plug their own laptops into the auditorium podium?

1 Sixteen schools present consecutively in one afternoon, so all slides run from one auditorium PC to save changeover time.

2 Personal laptops are illegal inside Civic Auditorium.

3 Only paper flip-charts are used at the symposium.

4 The auditorium has no projector screen.

(25) Why must teams embed fonts and submit both .pptx and PDF versions by Tuesday?

1 Standard fonts cost extra money on Saturdays.

2 PDF files automatically add background music.

3 Tuesday is the day after the symposium.

4 Custom fonts from Macs or tablets can disappear or break layouts on the auditorium's Windows PC.

(26) Why cannot presenters link slides to online videos on YouTube?

1 Videos longer than one second are banned.

2 Auditorium Wi-Fi is switched off during presentation sessions.

3 Windows computers cannot play embedded video files.

4 Historical topics never involve film footage.

Distinguishing "Social Jetlag" from Sleep Debt

Most high schoolers and office workers know the groggy feeling of short weekday sleep, and many try to make up for six-hour weeknights by sleeping until eleven a.m. on Saturdays and Sundays. Catching extra rest certainly feels refreshing on Sunday afternoon. Yet chronobiologists—researchers who study the body's twenty-four-hour circadian clocks—have found that swinging wildly between early weekday alarms and late weekend sleep-ins creates a hidden disruption they call "social jetlag."

Every organ in the human body, from liver enzymes and gut bacteria to blood-pressure hormones, runs on daily timing cues coordinated by a master clock in the brain's hypothalamus. That master clock calibrates itself primarily by when bright morning light first hits the retina. Stay up until two a.m. on Friday and Saturday and draw the curtains until noon, and your biological clock shifts roughly two to three hours westward—essentially flying your internal organs from Tokyo to Bangkok for the weekend.

When Monday's six-thirty alarm rings, forcing yourself out of bed does not snap those internal clocks back into place immediately; the pancreas and digestive tract may still expect midnight rest while you eat breakfast. Epidemiological studies tracking thousands of adults and teens show that even among people who average seven and a half hours of sleep per night across the week, a weekend midpoint shift of two hours or more correlates with foggier Monday memory, mood dips, and poorer blood-sugar regulation.

Sleep clinicians do not advise exhausted students to forfeit rest altogether, of course. Rather than sleeping until noon, they recommend anchoring wake-up times within sixty to ninety minutes of weekday schedules, stepping into outdoor daylight right after rising, and taking a brief twenty-minute early-afternoon nap if needed.

Consistent rhythm, it turns out, nourishes the brain nearly as much as total hours on the pillow.

Distinguishing "Social Jetlag" from Sleep Debt — Questions

(27) What causes "social jetlag" according to chronobiologists?

1 Sleeping exactly eight hours from ten p.m. to six a.m. every single night.

2 Flying across the Pacific Ocean twice every Tuesday.

3 Shifting sleep and wake-up schedules back and forth by several hours between weekdays and weekends.

4 Drinking cold water before morning classes.

(28) What primary signal resets the master biological clock in the human brain each day?

1 When bright morning light first reaches the eyes.

2 The sound of a smartphone alarm ringtone.

3 Eating a heavy dinner at ten p.m.

4 Checking a wall calendar on Monday morning.

(29) What notable finding emerged even among people who averaged 7.5 hours of sleep across the week?

1 Anyone averaging 7.5 hours never felt tired on Mondays regardless of schedule.

2 Those whose weekend sleep shifted by two or more hours still showed Monday memory fog and poorer metabolic control.

3 Sleeping until noon on Sunday doubled math test scores.

4 Liver enzymes stopped working permanently after age twenty.

(30) What weekend strategy do sleep clinicians recommend instead of sleeping until noon?

1 Keep wake-up times within 60–90 minutes of weekdays, get morning outdoor light, and use a short early-afternoon nap if tired.

2 Set alarms two hours earlier on Sunday than on Tuesday.

3 Stay indoors behind dark curtains until four p.m.

4 Take a four-hour nap from six p.m. to ten p.m.

Distinguishing "Social Jetlag" from Sleep Debt — Questions (continued)

(31) Which statement best summarizes the passage's central conclusion?

1 Jet airplanes should ban flights between Tokyo and Bangkok.

2 High school students need only four hours of sleep if they wake at six.

3 Weekend sleep has no biological effect on internal organs.

4 Maintaining a steady daily sleep-wake rhythm matters nearly as much for health and alertness as total sleep duration.